

DIFFERENTIATING ASTRAL PROJECTION AND LUCID DREAMING

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The first quality to look for is your experience of your environment. AP experiences and lucid dreaming are often confused for one another. They both have a very real, tangible quality to them compared to a dream state, but there are clear differences:

First, how does time feel? By that I mean, is everything happening quickly and you feel rushed through a bunch of stuff happening to you or is it very chill, almost boring? The former case is likely to be LD and the latter AP.

Next, you can conduct a couple of quick exercises while the experience is happening. For example, just look straight ahead and note as much detail as possible about the scene. Then turn all the way around and come back to the same position you started in and looking at the exact same scene. Did you note changes to the scene, perhaps radical changes? Then it's very likely LD. If it stayed put like a good lil' reality, then it's probably AP.

Another quick test is to close your eyes (your projection's eyes, in this case). Then imagine the scene before changed in a specific way. For example, add a big oak tree front and center. Open your eyes. Did it manifest in the scene? If it did, you're probably LD. If reality remained obstinate, then you're likely having an AP experience.

Overall, both of these states are closely related to the sleeping state, but they can be thought of as increasing levels of wakefulness. In order, they are: Dreaming (REM), Lucid Dreaming, Astral Projection, Creative Visualization (meditation), Wakefulness.

Once you've had a few of each type of projections, it becomes very easy to differentiate because you'll immediately recognize the character of the place. I don't know what better words to use than those. Each world has a unique yet indescribable quality to the experience of it. Like riding a bike, once you get a feel for it, you immediately know where you are.

Also, the vast majority of the time, and especially your first few times, AP will start with you standing beside your physical body in a nearly-exact replica of your bedroom (or wherever you were in your physical body). Things should be still and nothing much should be happening. LD, on the other hand, starts wherever the dream was just before you transitioned states. So if you started out your experience as the captain of an 18th-century Spanish galleon in the middle of a naval battle, then this is very likely to be a LD experience.